Some Things You Need to Know Before the World Ends

By Larry Larson and Levi Lee

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(Pg 98-103) *Lights come up on the desk area where an official-looking man is rubber-stamping documents. Another man enters, looking sheepish. He is carrying an application.*

INTERVIEWER: *(Ringing bell on desk.)* Next! *(Goes back to stamping)*

APPLICANT: Excuse me.

INTERVIEWER: I'll be right with you.

APPLICANT: They, ah, told me ... *(The Interviewer continues to stamp more papers while applicant waits)*

INTRODUCTION

ACTOR 1: *God's busy, right? He doesn't have time to sift through every prayer asking for help.*
ACTOR 2: *To help out, over the centuries the Catholic Church has recruited patron saints to act as sort of receptionists to sort through your requests.*
ACTOR 1: *There are tons of patron saints. You name it, the Church probably has a saint for it.*
ACTOR 2: *You've heard of Saint Nicholas,*
ACTOR 1: *St. Patrick and St. Valentine*
ACTOR 2: *But did you know that there is also a Patron Saint of Fireworks?*
TOGETHER: *St. Barbara! *BOOM**
ACTOR 1: *Today we witness the application process of a new saint.*
ACTOR 2: *All hail, Saint Wally.*
TOGETHER: *Some Things you Should Know Before the World Ends by Larry Larson and Levi Lee*

INTERVIEWER: All right, what can I do for you?

APPLICANT: Well, they told me I should give this to you personally. *(Hands him the form.)*

INTERVIEWER: Oh, right. *(Reading.)* "Application for Sainthood."

APPLICANT: *(Beaming saintly.)* That's right!

INTERVIEWER: *(Reads it over:)* All right. Um. Hmm. You just have to answer these

questions at the bottom of the form.

APPLICANT: It said not to fill in below the line ...

INTERVIEWER: Well, that's right. But ...

APPLICANT: So I didn't.

INTERVIEWER: I see that.

APPLICANT: I try to follow all instructions exactly. I believe that a saint ...

INTERVIEWER: Well, you're not a saint yet are you?

APPLICANT: I guess not.

INTERVIEWER: Right. Now, I'll just ask you a few questions and we'll get this thing wrapped up.

APPLICANT: The sooner the better!

INTERVIEWER: Right. Okay. First question here is, "Why do you want to be a saint?"

APPLICANT: Well, it all started when I was a very young child. I saw a small bird with a broken wing lying on the ground ...

INTERVIEWER: Poor thing.

APPLICANT: It was a tiny fragile thing, but one of God's creatures all the same. I saw in that bird all of mankind ...

INTERVIEWER: It's there.

APPLICANT: I was only four years old at the time ...

INTERVIEWER: Very young ...

APPLICANT: ... but as I held that broken little body in my hands a soft, wonderful voice spoke in my ear, and she said "You can heal that bird." And I did. After that time, I knew somehow I was special. I tried to do everything by the book. I followed all the teachings of the church. I never cursed, not even in my heart. And I've heard my friends say, "Eh, that Wally, he's really a saint, eh?" And I started thinkin' humbly, in my heart that it might be true. And then I heard that same soft, wonderful voice, this time say, "Wally, why don't you go ahead and fill out an application?" So here I am!

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INTERVIEWER: *(Writing.)* "Wants to sit on the right hand of God." Now there's the question of martyrdom.

APPLICANT: Martyrdom?

INTERVIEWER: Of course, you know, dying a violent death before your time ... ?

APPLICANT: Against your will?

INTERVIEWER: Not necessarily. Now if you'll just tell me what kind of martyr's death you'd like to die ...

APPLICANT: Gee, I never thought about it.

INTERVIEWER: Most people haven't. We have several popular methods. *(He opens a large sample book like the ones banks use to feature personalized checks.)* Now, this is a real hot number ... *(Points with his pencil.)*

BOTH: Fire.

INTERVIEWER: Right. A lot of early saints went this way. Joan of Arc, to name a few

APPLICANT: I like that.

INTERVIEWER: Well, we have others. Here's a traditional martyrdom, if you're the old-fashion type, being torn apart by wild beasts.

APPLICANT: Well, it's very colorful ... but I'm kind of allergic to animal fur. I'd hate to sneeze myself to death!

INTERVIEWER: Of course. Well, here's one that's not used too often. Having your throat cut from ear to ear.

APPLICANT: That sounds festive. Let's keep that one in mind.

INTERVIEWER: Of course there's stoning.

APPLICANT: Too heavy.

INTERVIEWER: Crucifixion?

APPLICANT: Don't want to be a copycat.

INTERVIEWER: Beheading? Fast, simple . . *(Demonstrates with chopping motion.)*

APPLICANT: No, wanna keep my head.

INTERVIEWER: Oh, here's my personal favorite. Hot lead in the ears.

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APPLICANT: Oh, I like that! No, no, wait, my mum said never to put anything in your ear smaller than your elbow.

INTERVIEWER: Wise woman.

APPLICANT: No, I was really thinking of something a little more ... modern, eh? Like a couple of cases of beer and some Quaaludes.

INTERVIEWER: No, if that would work, Marilyn Monroe would be a saint.

APPLICANT: Janis Joplin.

INTERVIEWER: Jimi Hendrix.

APPLICANT: Elvis Presley.

INTERVIEWER: Oh, he *is* a saint.

APPLICANT: He is? I didn't know that.

INTERVIEWER: Check your calendar. Well?

APPLICANT: I don't know. I can't make up my mind.

INTERVIEWER: Here's one. How about the Big M package?

APPLICANT: Big M?

INTERVIEWER: A combo. Look, you can be crucified and torn apart by wild beasts, you can be torn apart by wild beasts and have hot lead poured in your ears, or you can be crucified, have hot lead poured in your ears, and be torn apart by wild beasts with hot lead poured in *their* ears! Drives 'em crazy.

APPLICANT: No, I think I'm gonna go with something simple ... I'm gonna go with having my throat cut ear to ear.

INTERVIEWER: Well, it's your funeral.

APPLICANT: Well, thanks a lot. I'll be seeing ya ...

INTERVIEWER: Wait a minute. Where are you going?

APPLICANT: Goin' back to Bemidji. You know, make a few arrangements, send out announcements, call the caterer ...

INTERVIEWER: In addition to martyrdom, we require three miracles.

APPLICANT: Three miracles.

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INTERVIEWER: Three miracles.

APPLICANT: Let's see. Does the bird count as one?

INTERVIEWER: Was he a lost cause?

APPLICANT: He was in pretty bad shape.

INTERVIEWER: Okay, I'm in a good mood today. *(Writes.)* Healed bird. Two more.

APPLICANT: Well, once I saw some kids knock down a spider's web, and the spider was left there homeless, so I repaired the web just by lookin' at it.

INTERVIEWER: That's it?

APPLICANT: Well, it's close work.

INTERVIEWER: *(Hesitates, looks at Applicant. He is wide-eyed, hopeful.) (Writes.)* Fixed web. One more.

APPLICANT: *(Thinks hard. Nothing comes.)* Gosh, let me think. One more. Jeez, I can't ...

INTERVIEWER: *(Correcting him.)* Uh, hmm ...

APPLICANT: Sorry, Christ, I ...

INTERVIEWER: Hmm .

APPLICANT: God! I . .

INTERVIEWER: Uh!

APPLICANT: *(Getting more upset, confused.)* Jesus Chris!

INTERVIEWER: *(Interviewer points with his pencil as if issuing a final warning.)* That's all right.

APPLICANT: I'm sorry. I just can't think of anything .... Oh, wait, there is one thing. Last summer, while I was on my vacation, I caused the sun to fall to the earth, infusin' all of mankind with its radiant light causin' them to be reborn in the Holy Spirit and thus live forever without fear, hunger or disease!

INTERVIEWER: Fear and hunger, eh?

APPLICANT: That's right.

INTERVIEWER: I'm sorry that's been taken.

APPLICANT: Oh no!!!

INTERVIEWER: I'm sorry.

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APPLICANT: But I want to be a saint.

INTERVIEWER: Sorry ...

APPLICANT: I've worked so hard. Couldn't you check your book ....

INTERVIEWER: You'll have to move on.

APPLICANT: But I want to be a saint!

INTERVIEWER: *(Angrily.)* You want to be a saint! Everybody wants to be a saint! It's not easy! They're laying saints offl Now get out of my office!

APPLICANT: *(Dejected, yet resigned.)* Well, I guess that's it. *(He pulls out a road map from his jacket.)* Might as well just get back in the al' Winnebago and head back to Bemidji ...

INTERVIEWER: Wait a minute. Is that your road map?

APPLICANT: Yup.

INTERVIEWER: Where did you get it?

APPLICANT: Picked it up at the Sunoco right near the house.

INTERVIEWER: Did you refold that yourself?

APPLICANT: Sure. *(Demonstrates.)* Hundreds of times.

INTERVIEWER: *(Holds up three fingers.)* That's three!

APPLICANT: That's it! I'm a saint! I'm a saint! Oh, boy, I'll have my own day! I hope it's a Thursday ... Saint Wally . . .

SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

IL State Qualifier
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SD State Qualifier

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